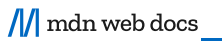


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Element.setAttribute()

Sets the value of an attribute on the specified element. If the attribute already exists, the value is updated; otherwise a new attribute is added with the specified name and value.

To get the current value of an attribute, use [getAttribute\(\)](#); to remove an attribute, call [removeAttribute\(\)](#).

Syntax

```
setAttribute(name, value)
```

Parameters

name

A string specifying the name of the attribute whose value is to be set. The attribute name is automatically converted to all lower-case when `setAttribute()` is called on an HTML element in an HTML document.

value

A string containing the value to assign to the attribute. Any non-string value specified is converted automatically into a string.

Boolean attributes are considered to be `true` if they're present on the element at all. You should set `value` to the empty string (`"`) or the attribute's name, with no leading or trailing whitespace. See the [example](#) below for a practical demonstration.

Since the specified `value` gets converted into a string, specifying `null` doesn't necessarily do what you expect. Instead of removing the attribute or setting its value to be [null](#), it instead sets the attribute's value to the string `"null"`. If you wish to remove an attribute, call [removeAttribute\(\)](#).

Return value

None ([undefined](#)).

Exceptions

`InvalidCharacterError` [DOMException](#)

The specified attribute `name` contains one or more characters which are not valid in attribute names.

Examples

In the following example, `setAttribute()` is used to set attributes on a [<button>](#).

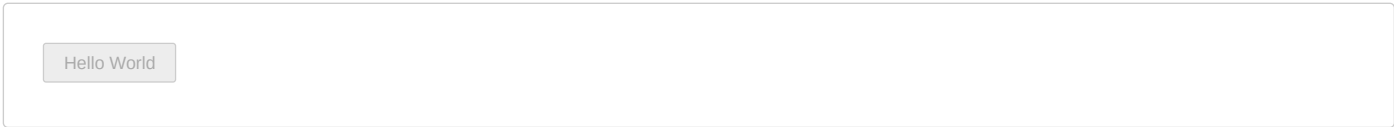
HTML

```
<button>Hello World</button>
```

JavaScript

```
const button = document.querySelector("button");

button.setAttribute("name", "helloButton");
button.setAttribute("disabled", "");
```



This demonstrates two things:

- The first call to `setAttribute()` above shows changing the `name` attribute's value to "helloButton". You can see this using your browser's page inspector ([Chrome](#) , [Edge](#) , [Firefox](#) , [Safari](#)).
- To set the value of a Boolean attribute, such as `disabled` , you can specify any value. An empty string or the name of the attribute are recommended values. All that matters is that if the attribute is present at all, *regardless of its actual value*, its value is considered to be `true` . The absence of the attribute means its value is `false` . By setting the value of the `disabled` attribute to the empty string (`"`), we are setting `disabled` to `true` , which results in the button being disabled.

DOM methods dealing with element's attributes:

Not namespace-aware, most commonly used methods	Namespace-aware variants (DOM Level 2)	DOM Level 1 methods for dealing with <code>Attr</code> nodes directly (seldom used)	DOM Level 2 namespace-aware methods for dealing with <code>Attr</code> nodes directly (seldom used)
setAttribute (DOM 1)	setAttributeNS	setAttributeNode	setAttributeNodeNS
getAttribute (DOM 1)	getAttributeNS	getAttributeNode	getAttributeNodeNS
hasAttribute (DOM 2)	hasAttributeNS	-	-
removeAttribute (DOM 1)	removeAttributeNS	removeAttributeNode	-

Specifications

Specification
DOM Standard # ref-for-dom-element-setattribute①

Browser compatibility

[Report problems with this compatibility data on GitHub](#)

	Chrome	Edge	Firefox	Opera	Safari	Chrome Android	Firefox for Android	Opera Android
<code>setAttribute</code>	Chrome 1	Edge 12	Firefox 1	Opera 8	Safari 1	Chrome 18 Android	Firefox 4 for Android	Opera 10.1 Android

Tip: you can click/tap on a cell for more information.

Full support

Gecko notes

Using `setAttribute()` to modify certain attributes, most notably `value` in XUL, works inconsistently, as the attribute specifies the default value. To access or modify the current values, you should use the properties. For example, use `Element.value` instead of `Element.setAttribute()`.

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